

Refinement and Publication Introduction: Training Guide

Training Goals:

1. The audience will understand that:

- ☐ Quality, accessible Scripture requires:
 - quality checking from the very beginning of the drafting process, and
 - refinement and consistency checks after the 8 Steps are complete for the entire translation.
- ☐ Printing requires additional refinement activities to fix typos and formatting issues.
- ☐ Wycliffe Associates offers refinement resources that help to improve the quality of the finished translation.

2. The audience will be able to:

- ☐ Anticipate the sequence of the refinement activities.
- ☐ Plan for the necessary time to refine their translation before they print it.

Estimated Time: 30-45 minutes

Materials: ✓ Slides: *Refinement and Publication Introduction - Slides (Optional)*

Introduction: Wycliffe Associates has celebrated many New Testament and Old Testament completions! This workshop is about the process for a community to prepare their Bible for printing.

There are four activities that can help to ensure that churches reach their goal of quality, accessible Scripture. Some of these will be topics that we have discussed before, but they will be covered in greater detail. Others will be new.



The Quality Assurance Process

Ask: When does the process of producing a quality translation begin?



Explain: As we discussed in COBT training, creating a clear and accurate translation **begins from the very start**. Some of the specific activities to ensure accuracy include:

- the 4 Checking Steps,
- the *Quality Assessment Guide*,
- the *Divine Familial Terms Tables*, and
- the *Reviewers' Guide*.



These activities are very important for the quality of the finished translation. Because of this, we are going to review and dive deeper into two of them: the *Quality Assessment Guide*, and the *Reviewers' Guide: New Testament Survey*.

In addition to these existing processes for quality assurance, Wycliffe Associates (WA) has also developed two new tools:

Note: The *Divine Familial Terms* (DFT) check is not required for communities who have no problems with understanding and translating these terms accurately. For teams who do struggle with these terms, the *DFT Tables* are required. They should complete the *DFT Tables* before their translation is considered complete. However, if the team has completed their translation and still has any questions about these terms, DFTs should be reviewed and checked during the Spiritual Terms training.

Refinement and Publication Introduction

The first tool is called the ***Spiritual Terms Evaluation Tool***. It is a computer-based tool that creates a print-out. This tool enables translators to make sure that some important words have been translated consistently throughout a completed New Testament, even though different translators worked on different books.

The second tool is a ***Proofreading Checklist***

Each checking or refinement activity allows the community to greatly improve the quality of their finished translation. Each step is like a different filter, checking the translation for different traits.

Note: If the team is planning to publish through WA, make sure they understand that there will be accountability for finishing each of the refinement activities. Each refinement step has physical (on-paper) verification for completion.

Additional Refinement before Printing

Ask: When translators begin a new project, what is their goal? What is the product they long for?

Use the sample question, or use other culturally relevant questions to lead the audience to the power of discovery.



Explain: For many communities, the goal of translation is a printed Bible. However, getting the text from the completed files into a printed book takes some special work. This workshop talks about the activities that are necessary to produce a quality printed work.



Typos, inconsistent translation, and common formatting and spelling mistakes all need to be found and corrected when preparing to print a quality Bible. Refinement activities such as proofreading will catch typing errors that were not found earlier. (These errors are especially difficult to find earlier if typing is done as a separate process, after the checking steps have been done on handwritten work.)

Overview of Four Refinement Activities and their Timing

Notice that several refinement activities are used during the 8-step translation process, while others are used after the Eight Steps are complete.



Activity	When is it used?	Who uses this?
Checking Steps	During the Eight Steps	Translators
* <u>Quality Assessment Guide</u> *	Trained after the Eight Steps, used throughout the translation project, confirmed with a checklist during refinement	Translators
* <u>Divine Familial Terms Tables</u> *	Trained after the Eight Steps, used throughout the translation project and confirmed with a checklist	Translators in communities where there are issues with Divine Familial Terms
* <u>Reviewers' Guide: NT Survey</u> *	Used after NT is completed, when the project files have been completed and are accessible on bibleineverylanguage.org	Mother-tongue believers not on the translation team, led by a member of the translation team

Refinement and Publication Introduction

* <u>Spiritual Terms Evaluation Tool</u> *	Used after NT is complete, when the project files have been completed and are accessible on bibleineverylanguage.org	Translators with other spiritual leaders
Proofreading	LAST step, right before publishing	One or more translators

Ask:

- How long do you think the refinement activities will take?
- How can we prepare translators at the beginning of refinement so that this will not discourage them?

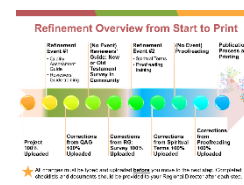
Explain: These activities will take time, but it is time well spent.

WA's publication team prepares translation files for printing after a translation is complete. This team must spend many months working out the details and formatting to be able to print Bibles.

Often, errors aren't noticed until the translation files are sent to the publication team. Then, the printing is delayed as our team must communicate back and forth with the translation team to ask them to fix the mistakes in formatting and consistency that our team can see. However, our team only speak and read English, so there are many kinds of errors in typing and spelling that they cannot find in other languages.

The translation team can use these important refinement activities to find and fix mistakes in the translation files on their own, including the errors that are made during the typing process. These refinement activities will make all the separate parts of the translation beautiful, correct, and consistent before Bibles are printed for the whole community.

Explain: This graphic is an overview of the entire translation process. Notice the different stages. It shows when events can be planned for further training. It also shows what refinement activities have to be complete before the next activity can begin. "Complete" means that all corrections are typed and uploaded.



Confirm:

1. The audience understands that:

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- Printing requires additional refinement activities to fix typos and formatting issues.
- Wycliffe Associates offers refinement resources that help to improve the quality of the finished translation.

2. The audience is able to:

- Anticipate the sequence of the refinement activities.
- Plan for the necessary time to refine their translation before they print it.

